

S&P Global US Flash PMI®

Business growth surges to fastest for over five years and job gains accelerate, but price pressures also intensify amid spike in costs

September 2026

Flash US Composite PMI Output Index: 58.4
(August: 56.0). 62-month high.

Flash US Services PMI Business Activity Index: 58.7 (August: 56.5). 59-month high.

Flash US Manufacturing Output Index: 56.7
(August: 53.1). 53-month high.

Flash US Manufacturing PMI: 57.0 (August: 53.9).
52-month high.

US business activity growth accelerated for a fourth successive month in September to reach the fastest rate for over five years. A further surge in service sector business activity was accompanied by a renewed improvement in manufacturing output growth. Employment also rose sharply, with jobs added at a pace not seen for over four years, as firms sought to meet rising demand. However, backlogs of work continued to rise at an increased rate and supply chain delays intensified, pointing to a lack of operating capacity which fed through to higher prices. Input costs meanwhile surged higher on the back of the recent spike in energy prices, adding to a worsening inflation picture.

Output and demand

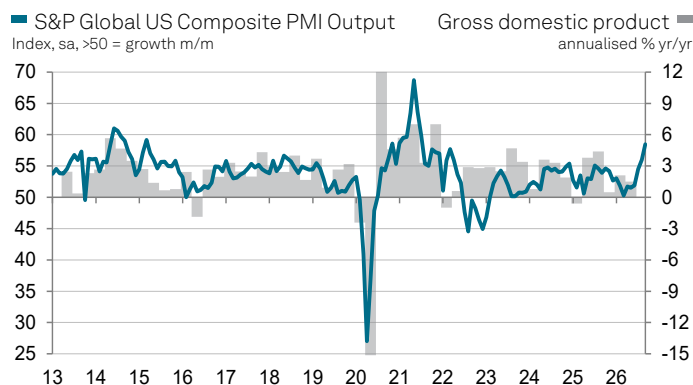
The headline flash S&P Global US PMI Composite Output Index rose from 56.0 in August to 58.4 in September, registering the fastest expansion since July 2021 and an acceleration of growth for a fourth successive month. Growth was driven by the service sector, which reported the steepest rise in output for over five years, but a welcome development in September was an accompanying acceleration of manufacturing output growth to the fastest since April 2022.

New order inflows also gathered pace in both sectors, with growth reaching the highest since March 2022 in the service sector and the highest since April 2022 in manufacturing. In both cases, demand was buoyed principally by the domestic market, as goods export volumes continued to fall and services exports rose only modestly.

Employment and operating capacity

Companies' backlogs of uncompleted orders, a key indicator of capacity utilization and future business growth, rose in September at the sharpest rate since May 2022, having accumulated at increased rates in both manufacturing and services.

The rise in backlogs of work encouraged firms to take on more



Data were collected 10-22 September 2026.

Sources: S&P Global PMI, Bureau of Economic Analysis via S&P Global Market Intelligence.
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Comment

Chris Williamson, Chief Business Economist at S&P Global Market Intelligence:

"US business continues to boom, with output growing at the fastest rate for over five years in September. Historical comparisons suggest that the latest survey data point to annualized growth of around 5% with a 4% gain now signalled for the third quarter as a whole."

"To put the growth surge in context, barring the spike in demand following the opening up of the economy after the COVID-19 lockdowns, the latest improvement in business activity is the greatest recorded since early 2015. Business is clearly booming now in both manufacturing and services."

"However, this growth is being accompanied by some of the most severe supply chain bottlenecks seen in the near-two-decade survey history if the pandemic is excluded, with companies also reporting increasing problems finding suitable staff. Backlogs of work are consequently rising sharply. While this accumulation of uncompleted orders bodes well for the further expansion of output and capacity in the coming months, it also indicates that companies are developing more pricing power, and hence is a worry for the inflation outlook."

"Firms' input costs have meanwhile jumped in September at the steepest rate for four years, with fuel and transport costs spiking higher thanks to the rise in oil prices seen during the month, which will add further to the upward pressure on selling prices and inflation in the coming months."

staff. Employment consequently rose in September at a rate not seen since June 2022 and a pace rarely exceeded since comparable data were first available in 2009. Both service sector and manufacturing payrolls increased, the former at the fastest rate since June 2022 and the latter notably to the greatest extent since February 2021.

Future sentiment

Business output expectations for the year ahead were unchanged in September, having regained their pre-war level in recent months. Business expansion plans reflected reports of confidence being buoyed by signs of ongoing demand growth and economic resilience. Manufacturers remained more upbeat than service providers, and factory confidence has more or less returned to its long-run average. In contrast, service providers' sentiment remained well below trend level amid worries over cost-of-living concerns, higher borrowing costs and political uncertainty.

Prices

Price pressures intensified in September. Average input costs measured across both goods and services surged higher, the overall rate of inflation hitting the highest since October 2022. The increase was blamed widely on higher fuel and transport costs, though wage pressures were also noted to have picked up in many cases.

In manufacturing, high raw materials prices were also often linked to supply shortages; suppliers' delivery times lengthened markedly again in September on average, with the incidence of supply chain delays the most widespread since July 2022. Input cost inflation in manufacturing nonetheless remained below the peaks seen earlier in the year, during the initial months of the war in the Middle East. Service sector input cost inflation hit the highest since November 2022.

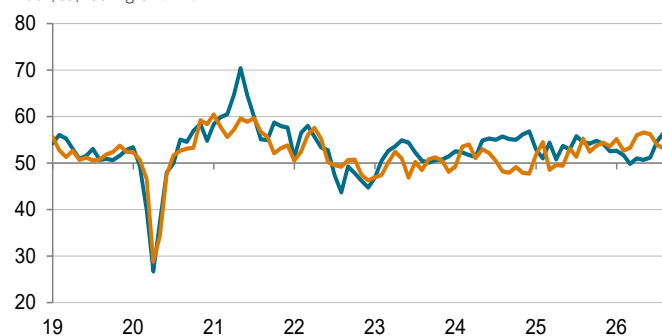
Selling price inflation also picked up in September, though was muted by competition in some instances, notably in the service sector. While above that seen in August, September's overall selling price rise was below the rates seen between March and July.

Manufacturing PMI

The S&P Global US Manufacturing PMI jumped from 53.9 in August to 57.0 in September, according to the flash reading, registering the strongest improvement in business conditions since May 2022.

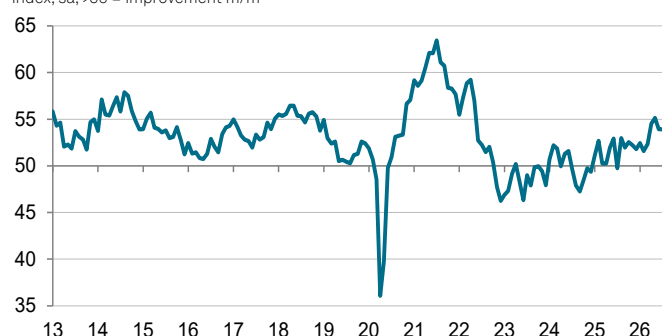
All five components helped boost the PMI. Production growth revived after having waned over the prior three months, reaching its fastest since April 2022, as new orders growth also accelerated to the fastest in nearly four-and-a-half years. Jobs growth hit the highest since February 2021, and inventories rose at an increased rate. Suppliers' delivery times meanwhile lengthened to the greatest degree since July 2022.

■ US Services PMI Business Activity
■ US Manufacturing PMI Output
Index, sa, >50 = growth m/m



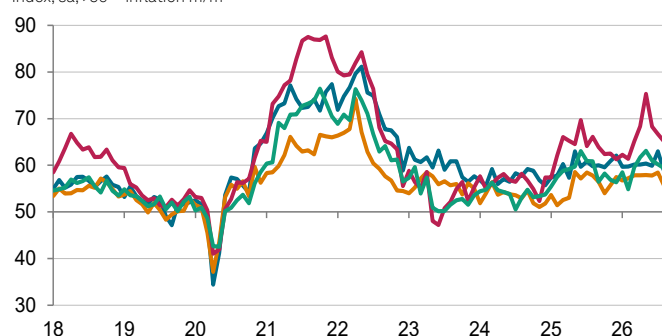
Source: S&P Global PMI. ©2026 S&P Global.

S&P Global US Manufacturing PMI
Index, sa, >50 = improvement m/m



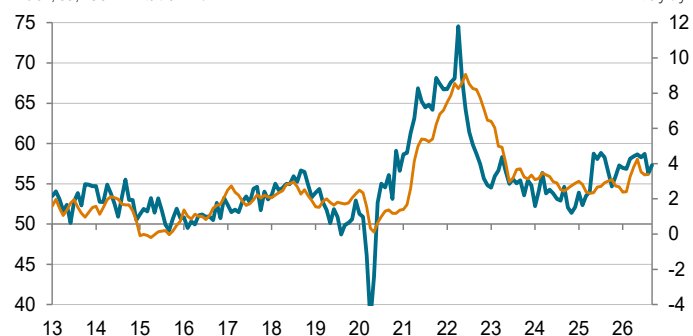
Source: S&P Global PMI. ©2026 S&P Global.

■ Services PMI Input Prices ■ Manufacturing PMI Input Prices
■ Services PMI Prices Charged ■ Manufacturing PMI Output Prices
Index, sa, >50 = inflation m/m



Source: S&P Global PMI. ©2026 S&P Global.

■ US Composite PMI Output Prices ■ Consumer prices
Index, sa, >50 = inflation m/m % yr/yr



Sources: S&P Global PMI, Bureau of Labor Statistics via S&P Global Market Intelligence.
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Methodology

Final September data are published on 1 October for manufacturing and 5 October for services and composite indicators.

The S&P Global Flash US Composite PMI® is compiled by S&P Global from responses to questionnaires sent to survey panels of around 650 manufacturers and 500 service providers. The panels are each stratified by detailed sector and company workforce size, based on contributions to GDP. The services sector is defined as consumer (excluding retail), transport, information, communication, finance, insurance, real estate and business services.

Survey responses are collected in the second half of each month and indicate the direction of change compared to the previous month. The following variables are monitored:

Manufacturing: Output, new orders, new export orders, backlogs of work, stocks of finished goods, employment, quantity of purchases, suppliers' delivery times, stocks of purchases, input prices, output prices, future output.

Services: Business activity, new business, new export business, outstanding business, employment, input prices, prices charged, future activity.

A diffusion index is calculated for each manufacturing and services variable. The index is the sum of the percentage of 'higher' responses and half the percentage of 'unchanged' responses. The indices vary between 0 and 100, with a reading above 50 indicating an overall increase compared to the previous month, and below 50 an overall decrease. The indices are then seasonally adjusted.

Composite indices for are calculated by weighting together comparable manufacturing and services indices using official manufacturing and services annual value added.

The headline figure is the Composite Output Index. This is a weighted average of the Manufacturing Output Index and the Services Business Activity Index. It may be referred to as the 'Composite PMI' but is not comparable with the headline Manufacturing PMI, which is a weighted average of five manufacturing indices (including the Manufacturing Output Index).

The headline manufacturing figure is the Manufacturing Purchasing Managers' Index™ (PMI®). The PMI is a weighted average of the following five indices: New Orders (30%), Output (25%), Employment (20%), Suppliers' Delivery Times (15%) and Stocks of Purchases (10%). For the PMI calculation the Suppliers' Delivery Times Index is inverted so that it moves in a comparable direction to the other indices.

The headline services figure is the Services Business Activity Index. This is a diffusion index calculated from a single question that asks for changes in the volume of business activity compared with one month previously. The Business Activity Index is comparable to the Manufacturing Output Index. It may be referred to as the 'Services PMI' but is not comparable with the headline Manufacturing PMI.

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Flash data are calculated from around 80-90% of total responses and are intended to provide an accurate early indication of the final data. Since flash data were first processed, the average differences between final and flash index values for the headline indices are:

Composite Output Index = 0.1 (absolute difference 0.4)

Services Business Activity Index = 0.1 (absolute difference 0.4)

Manufacturing PMI = 0.0 (absolute difference 0.3)

S&P Global do not revise underlying survey data after first publication, but seasonal adjustment factors may be revised from time to time as appropriate which will affect the seasonally adjusted data series. Historical data relating to the underlying (unadjusted) numbers, first published seasonally adjusted series and subsequently revised data are available to subscribers from S&P Global.

For further information on the PMI survey methodology, please contact economics@spglobal.com.

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